Digital Literacy Project Report

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INTRODUCTION

This project was completed as part of my Digital Literacy course, where I took on the role of a Student Digital Ambassador. The main aim was to help my peers better understand the digital world—how to use online tools effectively, communicate in a professional way, and stay safe from cyber threats. In today's fast-moving digital environment, these skills are very important, and this project gave me a chance to explore and practice them in a hands-on way.

Through the five tasks, I worked with different platforms and tools that are commonly used in both academics and professional settings. Each task helped me understand not just how these tools work, but also how they can be applied in real-life situations, whether it's creating content, working in teams, or organizing information.

One of the most valuable things I learned was how to build and maintain a professional online presence. I also became more aware of the importance of being responsible online and understanding cybersecurity risks. Overall, this project helped me improve my technical knowledge, communication skills, and thinking ability. It has made me more confident in using digital platforms and better prepared for my future academic journey and career.

TASK 1: Digital Literacy Infographic

For this project, I designed an infographic slide on Canva titled "Essential Digital Skills for the Modern Student," built around three areas I felt mattered most: what digital literacy actually means, how to stay safe online, and how to communicate professionally over email.

The first section pushes back against the idea that using tools well is enough — real digital literacy means understanding the consequences of what you do online. The second offers practical safety habits, like verifying suspicious links and enabling two-factor authentication. The third contrasts the casual tone most of us default to in messages with the structured, considered approach that academic and professional emails actually require.

What genuinely surprised me during the process was how difficult it is to communicate complex ideas simply. Deciding what to cut was harder than deciding what to include. It taught me that good visual communication isn't just about what you say — it's about knowing when less is more.

TASK 2: Professional Portfolio

For this task, I set up profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle — three platforms that serve genuinely different purposes in a tech career, and each worth understanding on its own terms.

GitHub is where code lives and evolves. It's the industry standard for version control and collaboration, and over the next four years I plan to use it to host assignments, track how my technical skills develop, and eventually contribute to open-source projects. I've already started by setting up my profile README, which felt like a small but real first step.

LinkedIn is essentially a living resume — one that connects you to peers, alumni, and industry professionals in ways a static CV never could. I've added my educational details and intend to use it actively to find internships and stay across what's happening in the industry.

Kaggle is where the data science side comes in. My plan is to work through beginner competitions and real datasets, using it as a space to apply what I'm learning in class to problems that actually exist.

TASK 3: Platforms Exploration

For this task, I worked across two platforms — HackerRank and Google Workspace — each serving a very different purpose.

On HackerRank, I set up my profile and tackled the beginner-level Solve Me First challenge in Python. It was a straightforward start, but it genuinely helped me shake off the rust on core syntax and get back into the rhythm of thinking algorithmically.

On the collaboration side, I designed a five-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms — a mix of multiple-choice and short-answer questions — and linked it to a Google Sheet for live response tracking.

Both platforms are ones I can see sticking with me throughout college. HackerRank keeps my problem-solving sharp and preps me for technical interviews down the line. Google Forms and Sheets, meanwhile, make research and group work significantly less painful — less time managing data, more time actually understanding it.

TASK 4: Email Etiquette

In this task, I worked on writing two professional emails—one to request an extension for an assignment and another to apply for an internship. While doing this, I realized how important proper email etiquette really is. Small details like having a clear subject line, using a polite and respectful tone, and organizing the message properly can make a big difference in how the email is understood. I also learned that starting with a proper greeting and ending with a professional sign-off helps create a good impression.

This task helped me understand that digital communication is not just about what you say, but how you say it. A poorly written email can easily cause confusion or even give the wrong impression. For example, sending an unclear or overly casual email to a professor might seem disrespectful or careless. On the other hand, a well-written email shows that you are serious and professional.

Overall, this activity improved my communication skills and made me more confident in writing formal emails. I now understand that clear and respectful communication is important not only in college but also in future professional situations.

TASK 5: Cybercrime Awareness

While researching cybercrime, what really surprised me was that many scams don't use advanced hacking or complicated technology. Instead, they take advantage of simple human mistakes, lack of awareness, or situations where people feel rushed. For example, in UPI fraud cases, scammers don't hack into accounts—they just trick users into approving a payment by making it seem like they are receiving money. Realizing how easily this can happen was both surprising and a little worrying.

This made me understand that staying safe online is not only about using good technology, but also about being alert and careful as a user. Even a small mistake or moment of confusion can lead to financial loss. It showed me how important it is to stay calm and think before taking any action online.

Because of this, I plan to change one important habit. I will make sure to carefully check every payment request and notification before approving it, instead of acting in a hurry. I will also be more cautious when dealing with unknown people, especially if they try to create urgency. Most importantly, I will never share my OTP or UPI PIN with anyone. This awareness will help me stay safer and more confident while using online platforms.

Conclusion

Overall, this project helped me clearly understand how important digital literacy is in today's world. Before starting, I had a basic idea of using online tools, but through these tasks, I learned how to use them more effectively and responsibly. From creating visual content and building a professional online presence to practicing coding and understanding online safety, each part of the project added something valuable to my learning. I also realized that digital literacy is not just about technical skills, but also about how we communicate and behave online. Writing professional emails, managing online profiles, and being aware of cyber threats are all essential skills for students today. This project helped me become more confident in using digital platforms in a smart and organized way. These skills will definitely support me throughout my academic journey, especially in assignments, group projects, and presentations. In the long run, they will also help me build a strong professional identity and prepare me for future career opportunities. Overall, this was a very practical and useful learning experience that I can apply in real life

References

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• Prezi Presentation Tool — prezi.com

• VIT Bhopal University VITyarthi E-Learning Platform